

Weather & Climate

47 words · Weather & Climate

NOUNS

forecast

a statement predicting how the weather will develop over the coming hours or days

The forecast says it'll rain all weekend, so we might reschedule the barbecue.

sunshine

light and warmth from the sun

We got a bit of sunshine at lunchtime, which made a nice change.

thunderstorm

a storm involving thunder, lightning, and often heavy rain

A thunderstorm rolled in just as we were setting up the tent.

frost

a thin layer of ice that forms outdoors when the temperature drops below freezing overnight

There was frost on the windscreen this morning, the first of the year.

humidity

the amount of moisture present in the air

The humidity was unbearable, ninety percent according to my phone.

downpour

a sudden, heavy fall of rain

We got caught in a downpour on the way to the station and arrived completely soaked.

monsoon

a seasonal wind in South and Southeast Asia that brings heavy rain, or the rainy season it causes

Flights were delayed for hours once the monsoon set in.

temperature

a measurement, usually in degrees, of how hot or cold the air is

The temperature dropped to almost zero overnight.

breeze

a light, pleasant wind

There's a lovely breeze coming off the sea this evening.

heatwave

a period of unusually hot weather lasting several days or more

The whole city ground to a halt during last summer's heatwave.

climate

the general weather conditions typical of a particular region over a long period

The climate here is much drier than back home, even in winter.

gale

a very strong wind

A gale blew half the tiles off next door's roof.

wind chill

the drop in perceived temperature caused by wind against exposed skin

It's only two degrees, but the wind chill makes it feel like minus five.

squall

a sudden, violent gust of wind, often accompanied by rain or snow

A squall hit the harbour without warning, and the smaller boats scrambled for shelter.

ADJECTIVES

humid

(of air) containing a lot of moisture, which makes heat feel heavier

It gets so humid here in July that you're sweating before you've even left the house.

mild

(of weather) neither very hot nor very cold; pleasantly moderate

We've had a really mild winter so far, hardly any frost at all.

boiling

extremely hot (informal)

It was boiling on the tube this afternoon, I couldn't wait to get off.

overcast

(of the sky) covered in cloud, with no sunshine visible

It stayed overcast all day, we never even saw the sun.

muggy

unpleasantly warm and humid, with little or no breeze

It was so muggy last night I couldn't get to sleep.

torrential

(of rain) falling extremely heavily

Torrential rain hammered the roof for hours.

balmy

pleasantly warm, especially in the evening

We sat outside until midnight, it was such a balmy evening.

blustery

characterised by strong, gusty wind

It was a blustery afternoon, with leaves swirling everywhere.

freezing

extremely cold

Wear a hat, it's freezing outside today.

chilly

unpleasantly cool, though not freezing

It's a bit chilly this evening, I might grab a jumper.

windy

with a strong wind blowing

It was so windy on the seafront that my umbrella turned inside out.

temperate

(of a climate) mild, without extremes of heat or cold

Britain has a temperate climate, so proper heatwaves are still fairly rare.

sweltering

uncomfortably hot

We spent the afternoon sweltering in a flat with no air conditioning.

dreary

(of weather) dull, grey, and depressing

It's been a dreary week, nothing but grey skies since Monday.

arid

(of climate or land) extremely dry, with little or no rainfall

The region's arid climate makes farming almost impossible without irrigation.

inclement

(of weather) unpleasantly cold, wet, or stormy (formal)

The match was postponed due to inclement weather.

VERBS

pour

(of rain) to fall heavily and continuously

It poured for the entire journey home.

thaw

(of snow or ice) to melt as the temperature rises

The roads were still icy at dawn but had thawed by mid-morning.

PHRASAL VERBS

wrap up

to put on warm clothing before going outside
Wrap up warm, it's properly cold out there today.

chuck it down

to rain very heavily (informal, British)
Look outside, it's absolutely chucking it down.

brighten up

(of weather) to become sunnier after being dull or wet
It should brighten up by the weekend, fingers crossed.

COLLOCATIONS

heavy rain

rain that falls fast and in large quantities
Heavy rain is forecast for tomorrow morning, so take an umbrella.

urban heat island

a built-up area that stays significantly warmer than the surrounding countryside
It's basically an urban heat island: all that concrete just holds the heat.

scattered showers

brief spells of rain affecting different areas at different times, rather than the whole region at once
There'll be scattered showers on and off today, so keep an umbrella handy.

IDIOMS

come rain or shine

whatever the weather turns out to be; without fail
We go for a walk every morning, come rain or shine.

batten down the hatches

to prepare thoroughly for a difficult situation ahead (originally a nautical instruction given before a storm)
With the storm warning issued, shopkeepers battened down the hatches and closed early.

every cloud has a silver lining

even a difficult or unpleasant situation has some positive aspect
We missed the flight, but at least we got to see more of the city, every cloud has a silver lining, I suppose.

take a rain check

to postpone an invitation or plan until another time
Can I take a rain check on drinks tonight? I'm shattered.

steal someone's thunder

to take attention or credit away from someone, especially by announcing their news before they can
She announced the engagement before I could, completely stealing my thunder.

SET PHRASES

what's the weather like?

a standard way of asking someone to describe current or expected conditions
What's the weather like where you are? It's grey and miserable here.

so much for summer

a wry remark made when good weather ends abruptly
So much for summer! We've had about three sunny days all month.

there's a nip in the air

used to say the air feels noticeably cold,
especially in autumn or early morning

*There's definitely a nip in the air this morning,
autumn's on its way.*

MODERN SLANG

scorcher

a very hot day

*Forecast says tomorrow's going to be an absolute
scorcher.*